

Nics Marketing Growth Review

SITUATION

Nico Villalobos runs Nics Marketing, a positioning and conversion consultancy for e-commerce brands. He is a solo operator, and his pipeline was entirely outbound when we started: cold DMs, sent and tracked and qualified by hand. Every prospect cost the same scarce resource, his hours, including those that were never going to close. His binding constraint was not lead volume. It was **qualified hours**.

THE DECISION

Most marketing sites are built to capture every lead. We built one that deliberately turns leads away, because the bottleneck was Nico's calendar, not his traffic.

The site routes prospects into a five-step qualification assessment, scores them for fit, and passes only matches to a strategy call. Responses flow into his CRM automatically through no-code tooling, so a qualified prospect arrives already profiled. **The tradeoff was intentional:** a five-step form loses people who would have sent a one-line message. We traded volume for fit per hour.

RESULTS

50+

assessments completed over twelve months

10+

clients and deals closed from them

~1 in 5

completed assessments became a client

~10 hrs

manual work removed every week

That close rate is strong *because* of the gate, not despite it: anyone who finishes a five-step form has self-selected for intent. The recurring ten hours a week matter more than the build itself, a quarter of a working week returned permanently.

Fifty completions over twelve months is about one a week. The gate works, so the bottleneck has moved: the scarce resource is no longer wasted hours but **qualified prospects reaching the form at all**.

WHAT I WOULD DO NEXT

Tune the gate with closed-won data

Ten clients closed, forty did not. Comparing their answers shows which questions predict a good client, turning a static filter into one that sharpens with volume.

Cost: an afternoon. At ten wins, treat findings as hypotheses.

Instrument step-level drop-off

We know who finishes, not where the rest leave. If abandonment clusters at one step, the gate is mispriced there and cheap to fix. Without it, form changes are guesswork.

Cost: near zero, and it makes the other two non-speculative.

Feed the funnel without loosening the gate

Once volume is the constraint, the instinct is to shorten the form. That trades away what demonstrably works. Raise qualified traffic into an unchanged gate instead.

Cost: ongoing, and the slowest of the three to pay off.

WHAT TRANSFERS

The useful part was not the website. It was working out which constraint actually bound the business, then designing against that one instead of the obvious one. Nico did not need more leads. He needed fewer and better ones, and his hours back. That habit transfers: establish what is genuinely scarce before optimizing anything, because the default metric and the binding constraint are rarely the same number.